

12 Ways to Become Rent- or Mortgage-Free

Trying to reduce your monthly overhead? One of the most significant line items for anyone (in addition to groceries and transportation) is the cost of physically having a roof over your head. Following are a dozen suggestions for making this recurring monthly expense virtually disappear.

Some are immediate, others require more time and discipline. All require compromise and responsibility. But . . . and here's the important thing—they all work. If you are willing to do some work, being rent- or mortgage-free can happen for you . . . probably faster than you might think.

1. House-sitting

This is probably the most immediate method with the least amount of cash outlay. Normally, you are required to pay utilities, provide your own transportation (although depending

on the location, this is not always necessary to have), and pay the cost of actually getting yourself there if you are not already in the neighborhood. Aside from a possible ticket or distance-driving cost, the costs you are expected to pay are ones you'd be incurring anyway. This is a good idea for responsible people who have experience being completely in charge of pet and home care. If you are looking to find a cool pad in Paris for 24/7 partying, keep looking. You won't find it on this circuit. Authors and people whose income is not dependent on a particular location are also ideal house-sitting candidates, as are retirees and mature, responsible travelers.

2. House swap

This option is more for those who already own a home outright, and would like the benefit of having another place to visit that they do not have to take out a mortgage for. Retired or semiretired individuals are very well suited to this option. Again, responsible individuals only need apply. You wouldn't want your house trashed by a group of derelicts, and nobody else wants their home abused either. Be considerate.

